POSITIVE ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR (POB)

Real Organizational Situation: Tata Group during the COVID-19 Crisis

THE REAL ORGANIZATIONAL SITUATION

COVID-19 created unprecedented uncertainty for Indian organizations.

Employees faced disrupted operations, health concerns, changing work arrangements and uncertain business conditions.

Tata Group companies and Tata Trusts mobilized resources to support healthcare and communities.

The situation provides a useful setting to examine positive psychological capacities at work.

THE CLASSROOM QUESTION

Imagine you are an HR manager in a Tata company in April 2020.

Employees are anxious. Operations are disrupted. Nobody knows how long the crisis will last.

QUESTION:

What psychological strengths would help employees continue performing and adapting?

POSITIVE ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR

A Recent Infosys Situation

Building psychological resources in the age of AI, hybrid work and employee well-being

THE ORGANIZATIONAL SITUATION

Infosys operates with a large hybrid workforce.

Employees are navigating workload pressures, changing technology, AI-related uncertainty and new ways of working.

The organization has expanded employee well-being and mental-health support initiatives.

How can organizations build employees' psychological capacity—not merely reduce stress?

A RECENT INFOSYS INITIATIVE

Infosys trained its HR team in India as Mental Health First Aiders in collaboration with NIMHANS.

The objective is to create an early-support system for employees experiencing mental-health difficulties.

Infosys also reports multiple physical, emotional, social and digital well-being initiatives.

What positive psychological resources might such initiatives strengthen?

THE POB LENS

Positive Organizational Behavior focuses on positive psychological capacities that are:

- measurable
- developable
- relevant to workplace performance

“How do we reduce employee problems?”

“How do we build employee psychological resources?”

🎓 THE BIG IDEA

Traditional OB

“What is wrong with the employee?”

Positive OB

“What psychological strengths can we develop?”

POB focuses on positive psychological capacities that can be measured, developed and managed to support performance and flourishing.

🚫 POB IS NOT “THINK POSITIVELY”

BLIND POSITIVITY

“Everything will be fine!”

Ignores obstacles.

Does not create a pathway for action.

POSITIVE OB

“The proposal failed. I can learn from it, find another approach and try again.”

Acknowledges reality + builds psychological resources.

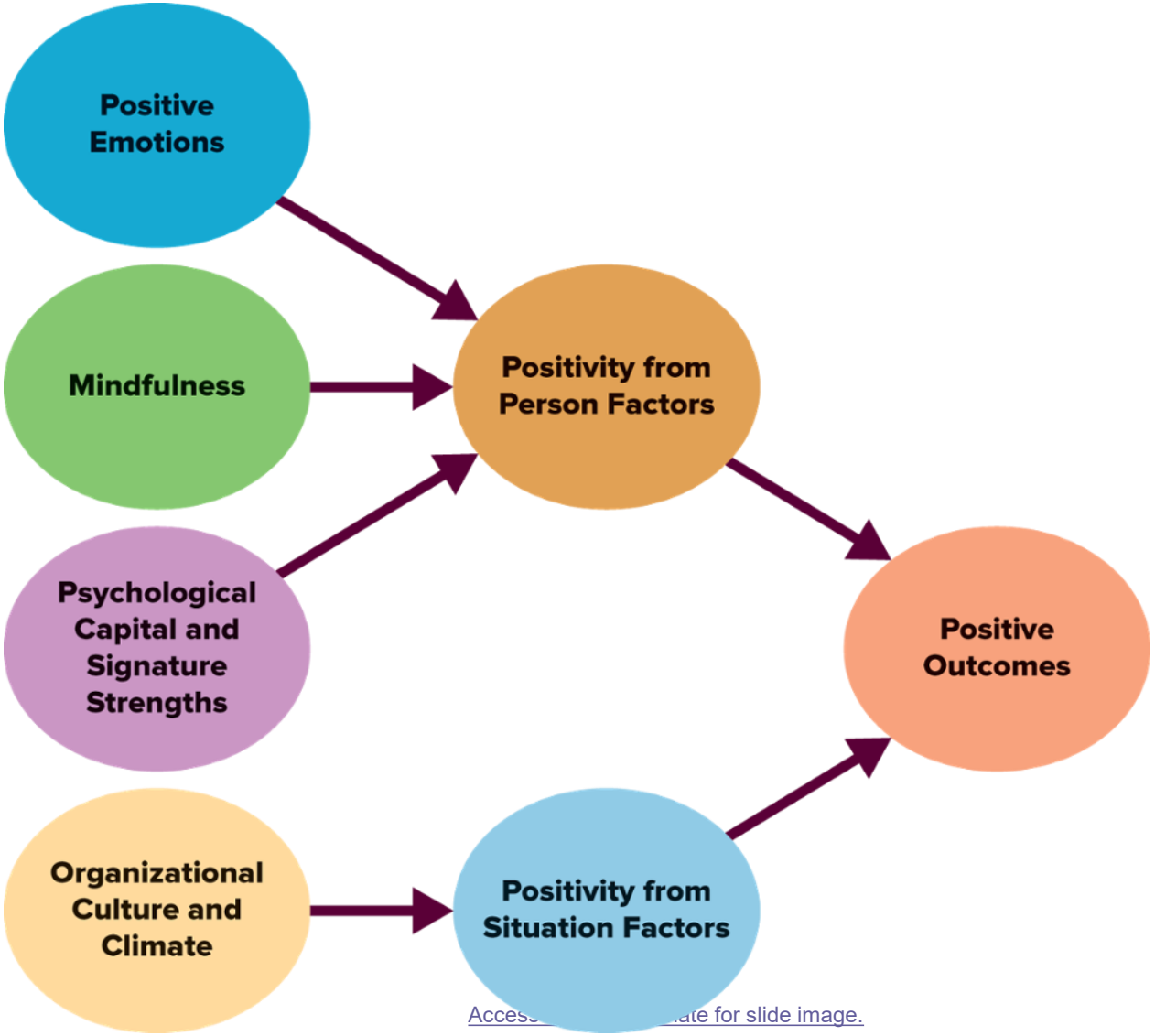
💡 **POB = positive resources + effective action**

What Is Positive Organizational Behavior?

The study and application of **positively oriented** human resource strengths and the psychological capacities that can be measured, developed, and effectively managed for improvement performance in today's workplace.

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How Positivity Works



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The Benefits of Positive OB

Positive deviance:

- Successful performance that dramatically exceeds the norm in a positive direction.

Associated with:

- Higher overall job performance.
- Less burnout.
- Increased commitment.
- Higher job satisfaction.
- Fewer sick days.

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The Power of Positive Emotions 1

Positive Emotions

- Are resources that fuel individual, group, and organizational success.
- Help build social, psychological, and physical resources.
- Combat negative emotions.
- Broaden your mindset, open you to consider new things.
- Have benefits which endure over long periods of time.

Negative Emotions

- Are limiting.
- Spur you to act in narrow or specific ways.

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The Power of Positive Emotions 2

Positive emotions have desirable effects on:

- Organizational commitment.
- Creativity.
- Decision making.
- Intentions to quit.
- Performance.
- Stress.

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The Power of Positive Emotions 3

They are contagious.

- Upward spirals of positivity, where positive behaviors, feelings, and attitudes feed your own and those of others in a continual, reinforcing process.

They can offset negative emotions.

- Need multiple positives experiences to counter a negative experience.

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Strategies to Increase Positivity

Create high-quality connections.

Cultivate kindness.

Develop distractions.

Dispute negative self-talk and thoughts.

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Test Your OB Knowledge 2

Stanley would like to increase his positivity. He should do all of the following EXCEPT:

A. establish social connections with co-workers, family, etc.

B. fake happiness.

C. go for a run when he feels negativity coming on.

D. use self-talk to stop negative thoughts.

E. volunteer to help a friend who is in a difficult situation.

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Mindlessness Versus Mindfulness 1

Mindlessness.

- State of reduced attention expressed in behavior that is rigid or thoughtless.
- Typified by a failure to control emotions.
- Requires minimal information processing.
- Automatic.
- Associated with poor mental and physical health.

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Mindlessness Versus Mindfulness 2

Mindfulness.

- The awareness that emerges through paying attention on purpose.
- Is in the present moment.
- Is nonjudgmental to the unfolding of experience moment by moment.
- Requires effort because the brain works in ways that detract from staying focused.
- Improves interpersonal communication.
- Requires attentional balance.

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Fostering Mindfulness

Inhibitors of mindfulness.

Attentional deficit:

- Inability to focus vividly on an object.

Attentional hyperactivity:

- Happens when our minds are racing or wandering, resulting in compulsive daydreaming or fantasizing.

Benefits of mindfulness.

- Increased physical, mental, and interpersonal effectiveness.
- More effective communications.
- More balanced emotions.
- Personal satisfaction.

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Test Your OB Knowledge 3

Which of the following about mindfulness is FALSE?

A. Mindfulness requires a person to be present in the moment.
B. Mindfulness decreases the effectiveness of interpersonal communications.
C. Attentional deficit inhibits mindfulness.
D. Mindfulness can be practiced.
E. Mindfulness enhances a person's ability to develop and sustain loving relationships.

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Positive Psychological Capital

Those with high levels of PsyCap have high levels of:

Hope.

Efficacy.

Resilience.

Optimism.

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Two Components of Hope

Waypower

- Means for achieving the goal.
- Need to see alternative paths to achieve the goal.

Willpower

- Having a goal and the determination to achieve it.

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Efficacy

Confidence in your ability to do something.

Influences the world around you and your ability to deal with inherent challenges and opportunities.

When high, leads to being more confident and positive .

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Resilience and Optimism

Resilience.

- Resiliency is the capacity to consistently bounce back from adversity and to sustain yourself in the face of challenges.

Optimism.

- Optimists view successes as due to their personal, permanent, and pervasive causes, and negative events to external, temporary, and situation-specific causes.
- Optimists are realistic and flexible.
- Optimism is self-inspirational.

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Test Your OB Knowledge 4

To have hope, one needs to have:

A. efficacy.

B. resilience.

C. mindfulness.

D. a goal and a means for achieving the goal.

E. optimism.

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Creating a Climate That Fosters Positive OB



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Benefits of Virtuous Leadership

Financial performance.

Customer satisfaction.

Positive organizational climate.

Measures of organizational effectiveness.

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Test Your OB Knowledge 5

The Positive Proton Company has a policy of using a panel of managers and various employees to resolve conflicts that arise. What organizational value does this represent?

A. Restorative justice.

B. Greater good.

C. Temperance.

D. Integrity.

E. Compassion.

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What Is Well-Being and Flourishing?

Well-being is the combined impact of five elements **(PERMA).**

P for Positive emotions.

E for Engagement.

R for Relationships.

M for Meaning.

A for Achievement.

Flourishing reflects the extent to which our lives contain PERMA.

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Well-Being and Flourishing 1

Positive Emotions.

- Broaden your perspective about how to overcome challenges in your life.
- Build on themselves resulting in a spread of positive emotions.
- Strengthens relationships with others (the R component in PERMA).

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Well-Being and Flourishing 2

Engagement.

- The extent to which you are physically, cognitively, and emotionally involved with an activity, task, or project.

Flow.

- State of being completely involved in an activity for its own sake

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Well-Being and Flourishing 3

Relationships.

- Positive emotions are associated with activities involving others.
- Social support is the amount of perceived helpfulness derived from social relationships.
  - Esteem support.
  - Informational support.
  - Social companionship.
  - Instrumental support.

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Well-Being and Flourishing 4

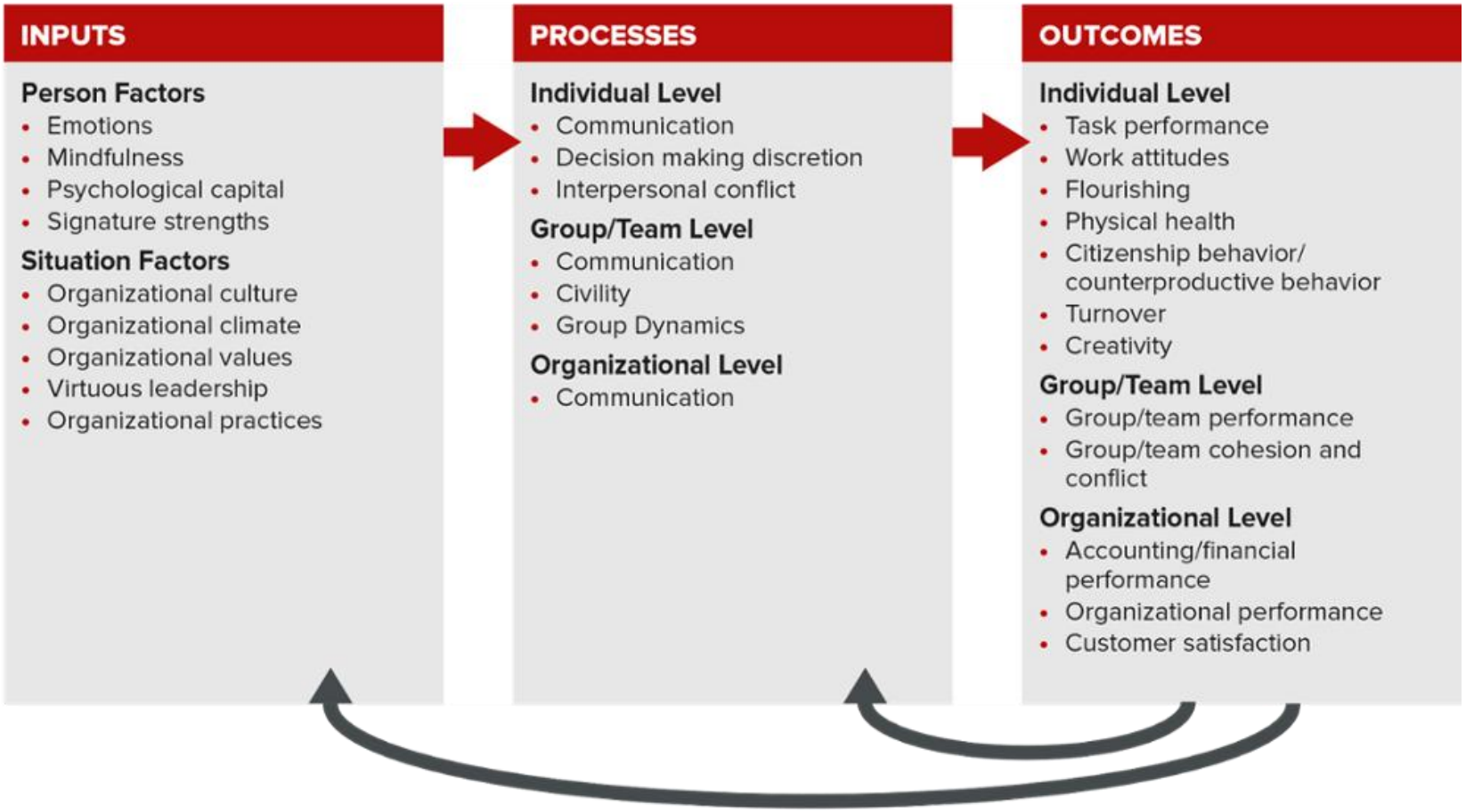
Meaningfulness and achievement.

- **Meaningfulness:**
  - When someone feels a sense of belonging and serving something that is bigger than self.
- **Achievement:**
  - Pertaining to the extent to which you have a self-directed life, containing achievement for its own sake.
- **Flourish:**
  - Occurs with achievement is pursued for its own sake.

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Positive Organizational Behavior: Putting It All in Context

Figure 7.4 Organizing Framework for Understanding and Applying OB



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🌱 PERMA: BUILD A FLOURISHING EMPLOYEE

Match each workplace example to the PERMA element.

Enjoys solving a challenging task

Feels connected to colleagues

Feels work serves a larger purpose

Feels proud of accomplishing a goal

Experiences gratitude and joy

POSITIVE EMOTIONS

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Complete ONE sentence:

“Positive OB is more than being positive because…”

OR

“The HERO dimension I would develop first in an employee is ___ because…”

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